

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE – Strategic Finance Leader

Senior Finance Business Partner | Finance Transformation | Decision Intelligence

Senior Finance Business Partner with a proven track record of transforming multi-entity, multi-currency finance operations to drive sustainable growth and measurable ROI. Skilled in leveraging automation, predictive analytics, and ERP systems to deliver actionable insights to CFOs and Boards, improved forecast accuracy, optimize capital allocation, and accelerate decision-making.

- Led multi-entity finance improvements using automation, Power BI, and Excel, analytics to streamline reporting, enhance forecasts
- Developed financial models and scenario analyses to guide capital allocation and monitor risk.
- Managed multi-currency operations, including FX, cash forecasting, financial analytics, providing insights for investment decisions.

Professional Mindset:

- **Investigator's mindset:** uncovering root issues others miss
- **Systems-builder's eye:** designing solutions that optimize finance-operational integration
- **Strategic partner's instinct:** aligning insights with business objectives to drive growth

EDUCATION, QUALIFICATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Postgraduate Diploma, Professional Accountant in Practice, SAIPA/FASSET | 2016 (NQF 8)

BCompt Accounting Science, University of South Africa | Oct 2023 (NQF 7)

Certificate, Financial Modelling & Valuation, Corporate Finance Institute (CFI) | Expected 2026

AI-Powered Data Insights Internship, Excelerate | Jul – Aug 2025

Virtual Finance & Corporate Projects, Forage | Nov – Dec 2025

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Financial Planning & Strategy:

- FP&A, Corporate Finance, Treasury management and cash forecasting
- Capital Allocation, Investment Strategy, Portfolio Management
- Budgeting & Forecasting, Scenario Planning, Cost Optimisation
- Financial Performance Management, Growth & M&A Advisory
- Financial Consolidations & Reporting

Risk, Investment & Governance:

- Credit & Counterparty Analysis, Investment Due Diligence
- Valuation (DCF, WACC), Portfolio Risk Oversight
- IFRS & JSE Reporting, Internal Controls / Process Oversight
- Liquidity risk management and ESG/sustainability risk oversight

Technical & Analytics Tools:

- **ERP & Accounting Systems:** SAP, Oracle, Adams, Dynamics, Sage, QuickBooks, Xero, Navision, Magnitude
- **Business Intelligence & Analytics:** Power BI (DAX, Power Query, Visualization, Reporting), Tableau
- Advanced Excel (pivot tables, macros, financial modelling for investment/valuation)
- Python (Pandas, NumPy, Predictive Analytics)
- KPI Automation, Finance Process Automation, Decision Intelligence Tools
- **Financial Platforms:** SARS e-filing, Chase, Accpac, Pastel Payroll, Valuation software

Leadership & Business Capabilities:

- Executive Stakeholder Engagement, Strategic Decision Support
- Change Management, Cross-Functional Leadership
- Mentoring & Team Development, Process Optimisation
- Sustainable Finance & ESG Awareness

JATIN CHOTOO

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<https://jatinchotoo.github.io>

- **Optimizer & Strategic Problem-Solver:** Drives efficiency, profitability, growth through structured analysis, scenario modelling, and system improvements

Professional Experience

Finance & Business Strategy Manager – (Contract) | J Segel and Associates Inc | Apr 2017 – Jan 2024 & July 2025 to current

- Delivered corporate finance advisory, FP&A insights, and strategic business planning, emphasizing investment strategy, capital allocation, and portfolio optimisation.

Key Achievements & Projects:

- Conducted investment due diligence, credit risk assessments, and portfolio oversight.
- Implemented finance transformation initiatives using ERP, AI, and automation to enhance investment-grade reporting and decision-making.
- Applied scenario modelling and ROI-focused strategies to optimise investment and business growth outcomes.
- Delivered FP&A dashboards and visualizations for senior leadership, enabling data-driven investment and capital allocation decisions

Havas Group – Financial Reporting Manager | Feb 2024 – Jun 2025

Role Overview: Reported to the CFO with accountability for FP&A, capital allocation, corporate finance advisory, investment strategy execution, and multi-entity financial reporting across African operations. Delivered executive-level insights to drive portfolio performance, capital allocation, and multi-currency investment decisions.

Key Achievements & Career Impact:

- Achieved **30% faster month-end close** across **7+ subsidiaries** via ERP automation, enabling immediate CFO and executive investment decision-making.
- Improved forecast accuracy by **20%** using scenario modelling and predictive analytics (Python, Power BI), guiding **R150M+ portfolio** and capital allocation decisions with **85%+ reliability**.
- Delivered **12% cost savings** and enhanced **operational ROI for 50+ employees** through strategic capital allocation and finance process automation.
- Drove 25% projected revenue growth by translating FP&A insights into actionable business decisions, including pricing optimisation and market expansion, impacting R50M+ shareholder value.
- **Reduced portfolio risk exposure by 15%** and improved cash flow predictability through advanced credit risk oversight across **100+ investment accounts**.
- Standardized global financial data architecture by leading cross-border teams, implementing consolidated reporting, multi-currency management, and predictive dashboards for investment-grade reporting.
- Built predictive forecasting and portfolio risk models (**85%+ accuracy**) to improve revenue visibility and proactively manage investment exposure.

Key Contributions / Strategic Decision Support:

- Delivered actionable insights enabling **25% projected revenue growth**, optimized capital allocation, and strengthened governance frameworks for high-value investment decisions.
- Liaised with internal and external auditors on multi-entity financial reporting, IFRS compliance, and process controls to ensure robust audit outcomes and regulatory adherence
- Partnered with auditors to review controls, validate multi-currency consolidations, and support investment-grade reporting across subsidiaries.

Notable Projects:

- Havas Group | 2024:** • ERP Transformation & Automation – Executive dashboards for capital allocation, investment scenario modelling, and KPI tracking.
- Developed real-time FP&A dashboards (Power BI, Python), reducing manual reporting by 30% and enhancing executive decision-making accuracy by 20%.
- **AI Internship | 2025: Predictive Revenue & Risk Analytics** - Random Forest, XGBoost, LightGBM models for portfolio and investment risk assessment.

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- **Forage Virtual Projects | 2025:** Investment & Valuation Simulation - Multi-scenario DCF/WACC analyses to inform risk-adjusted capital allocation strategies.

Finance & Advisory Leadership (FASSET) – DK Motiram & Company | Mar 2014 – Mar 2017

- Provided strategic financial advisory, FP&A, and corporate finance support for clients, including M&A and cross-border investment analysis.

Key Achievements:

- Improved budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis for client portfolios with focus on investment impact.
- Supported investment strategy, portfolio management, and risk mitigation.
- Advised clients on capital allocation using scenario planning and financial modelling.

Finance & Controls Training – Mahdi Meyer Steyn | 2013 – 2014

- Developed expertise in FP&A, treasury, financial governance, and investment risk management processes.
- Managed hedging and listed company FX exposure.

Trainee Accountant (SAICA) – Waterman's Services | 2007 – 2012

- Gained foundational experience in corporate finance, FP&A, treasury management, and investment reporting

Additional Information:

International Diploma, Computer Studies, University of Pretoria | 2003

- *Foundational IT skills supporting finance automation and analytics.*
- Languages: English (Fluent)
- **REFERENCES:** Available upon request.